London Borough of Camden
Information and Records Management
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Date: 31/07/2020
Ref: CAM247

Dear Requester

Thank you for your request for information dated 16/07/2020 about Disabled Persons Parking Badges. We have dealt with this under the Freedom of Information Act 2000.

Response

The council holds the information requested and the answers to your questions are as follows:

I make a formal Freedom of Information Request concerning Camden Council's implementation of the Department for Transports Guidance on the issuing of Disabled Persons Parking Badges, as per the link provided by yourselves: https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/blue-badge-can-i-get-one/can-i-get-a-blue-badge
Specifically, you have provided a link to the DFT Guidance, the question relates to your implementation of the Guidance.
The question is as follows:
Do Camden Council issue Disabled Persons Parking Badges 'only' to persons whom they are satisfied are disabled?
What proof satisfies Camden Council that a person is disabled?

The Council only issues Blue Badges to disabled people (including people with "hidden" disabilities) as defined in the legislation and referred to in the Department of Transport's guidance for local authorities as referenced in the enquiry. The proof required by the Council depends upon the criterion either cited or apparent in the application for the Badge. To summarise:

Criterion	**Proof**
Qualifying PIP award	Documentation detailing the award
Qualifying Disability Living Allowance award	Documentation detailing the award
Receives a War Pensioner's Mobility Supplement	Documentation detailing the award
Qualifying element of Armed Forces Compensation Scheme	Documentation detailing the award
Severely Visually impaired	CVI or DB8 document
Severe disability in both arms	Documentary evidence from an appropriate medical practitioner
Unable to walk	Documentary evidence from an appropriate medical practitioner or mobility assessment
Very considerable difficulty whilst walking	Documentary evidence from an appropriate medical practitioner or mobility assessment
Very considerable psychological distress while walking	Documentary evidence from an appropriate medical practitioner

Danger to themselves or others whist walking	Documentary evidence from an appropriate medical practitioner
Child under thee with bulky medical equipment	Documentary evidence from an appropriate medical practitioner

There may be occasions where the Council is flexible in its requirements of evidence of eligibility, but as these usually relate to unusual circumstances, it is not possible to generalise, i.e. each such case is taken on its merits. The Council does not make discretionary awards as the legislation does not allow for this, but to the best of its ability awards Blue Badges to qualifying disabled people.

Further Information:

We do not give our consent for any names and contact details provided in this response to be sent marketing material. Any such use will be reported to the ICO as a breach of General Data Protection Regulations and the Privacy and Electronic Communication Regulations.

Why not check our Portal Open Data Camden before making a new request as your question may already be answered by a previous FOI response or in one of our many useful and interesting datasets.

Your Rights

If you are not happy with how your response was handled you can request an Internal Review within 2 months of this letter by email to foireviews@camden.gov.uk or post: Information and Records Management Team, London Borough of Camden, Town Hall, Judd Street, London WC1H 9JE. Please quote your case reference number. If you are not satisfied with the Internal Review outcome you can complain to the Information Commissioner's Office at casework@ico.org.uk telephone 0303 123 1113, or post to Information Commissioner's Office, Wycliffe House, Water Lane, Wilmslow, Cheshire, SK9 5AF. The ICO website www.ico.org.uk may be useful.

Yours sincerely

Philip Lewis
Information Rights Officer